

Comprehensive Medical Reference Guide

Common Diseases and Their Symptoms

A structured medical information document covering common diseases, warning signs, symptom recognition, and specialist referrals.

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1 Introduction

This document provides a comprehensive overview of common medical diseases frequently encountered in primary care and hospital settings. It is intended for educational, reference, and knowledge retrieval purposes. Each disease section includes:

- Definition
- Causes and risk factors
- Common symptoms
- Warning signs and emergency symptoms
- When to consult a physician
- Recommended medical specialist

2 Heart Disease

2.1 Definition

Heart disease refers to a group of disorders affecting the heart and blood vessels, including coronary artery disease, heart failure, arrhythmias, congenital heart defects, and valvular disease.

2.2 Common Types

- Coronary Artery Disease (CAD)
- Heart Failure
- Arrhythmias
- Cardiomyopathy
- Valvular Heart Disease

2.3 Risk Factors

- Smoking
- Obesity
- High cholesterol
- Hypertension
- Diabetes
- Family history
- Sedentary lifestyle

2.4 Common Symptoms

- Chest pain or pressure
- Shortness of breath
- Fatigue
- Palpitations
- Swelling in legs or ankles
- Dizziness

2.5 Warning Signs

- Crushing chest pain
- Pain radiating to arm, jaw, or back
- Severe breathlessness
- Sudden fainting
- Cold sweating

2.6 When to See a Doctor

Consult a physician for persistent chest discomfort, reduced exercise tolerance, or abnormal heartbeat.

2.7 Specialist to Visit

Cardiologist

3 Diabetes Mellitus

3.1 Definition

Diabetes is a metabolic disease characterized by elevated blood glucose levels due to insulin deficiency or resistance.

3.2 Types

- Type 1 Diabetes
- Type 2 Diabetes
- Gestational Diabetes

3.3 Risk Factors

- Obesity
- Family history
- Poor diet
- Physical inactivity
- Age above 45

3.4 Common Symptoms

- Frequent urination
- Excessive thirst
- Increased hunger
- Weight loss
- Fatigue
- Blurred vision
- Slow wound healing

3.5 Warning Signs

- Fruity breath odor
- Confusion
- Severe dehydration
- Vomiting
- Loss of consciousness

3.6 When to See a Doctor

If experiencing persistent thirst, frequent urination, or unexplained weight changes.

3.7 Specialist to Visit

Endocrinologist

4 Hypertension

4.1 Definition

Hypertension is persistently elevated blood pressure, usually above 140/90 mmHg.

4.2 Risk Factors

- High salt intake
- Obesity
- Stress
- Smoking
- Alcohol use
- Family history

4.3 Common Symptoms

Often asymptomatic, but may include:

- Headaches
- Dizziness
- Nosebleeds
- Vision problems

4.4 Warning Signs

- Severe headache
- Chest pain
- Confusion
- Blurred vision
- Shortness of breath

4.5 When to See a Doctor

If repeated blood pressure readings remain elevated.

4.6 Specialist to Visit

Cardiologist or Internal Medicine Specialist

5 Asthma

5.1 Definition

Asthma is a chronic inflammatory airway disease causing reversible airway narrowing.

5.2 Triggers

- Dust
- Pollen
- Exercise
- Cold air
- Smoke
- Respiratory infections

5.3 Common Symptoms

- Wheezing
- Coughing
- Chest tightness
- Breathlessness

5.4 Warning Signs

- Difficulty speaking
- Blue lips
- Severe wheezing
- No relief with inhaler

5.5 When to See a Doctor

If symptoms occur multiple times weekly or worsen at night.

5.6 Specialist to Visit

Pulmonologist

6 Arthritis

6.1 Definition

Arthritis is inflammation of joints causing pain, stiffness, and reduced mobility.

6.2 Types

- Osteoarthritis
- Rheumatoid Arthritis
- Gout

6.3 Common Symptoms

- Joint pain
- Stiffness
- Swelling
- Redness
- Reduced range of motion

6.4 Warning Signs

- Sudden severe swelling
- Fever with joint pain
- Inability to move joint

6.5 When to See a Doctor

If joint pain persists beyond several weeks.

6.6 Specialist to Visit

Rheumatologist

7 Kidney Disease

7.1 Definition

Kidney disease involves gradual or sudden loss of kidney function.

7.2 Causes

- Diabetes
- Hypertension
- Kidney stones
- Infections

7.3 Common Symptoms

- Swelling
- Reduced urine output
- Fatigue
- Nausea
- Foamy urine

7.4 Warning Signs

- Blood in urine
- Severe swelling
- Shortness of breath
- Confusion

7.5 When to See a Doctor

Persistent urinary abnormalities or unexplained swelling.

7.6 Specialist to Visit

Nephrologist

8 Liver Disease

8.1 Definition

Liver disease includes disorders affecting liver function such as hepatitis, cirrhosis, and fatty liver disease.

8.2 Common Causes

- Viral hepatitis
- Alcohol
- Obesity
- Medications

8.3 Common Symptoms

- Jaundice
- Fatigue
- Abdominal pain
- Nausea
- Dark urine

8.4 Warning Signs

- Severe abdominal swelling
- Confusion
- Vomiting blood
- Black stools

8.5 When to See a Doctor

Yellowing of eyes or persistent abdominal discomfort.

8.6 Specialist to Visit

Hepatologist or Gastroenterologist

9 Anemia

9.1 Definition

Anemia is a condition characterized by reduced red blood cells or hemoglobin.

9.2 Causes

- Iron deficiency
- Vitamin B12 deficiency
- Blood loss
- Chronic disease

9.3 Common Symptoms

- Fatigue
- Pale skin
- Weakness
- Dizziness
- Shortness of breath

9.4 Warning Signs

- Chest pain
- Fainting
- Rapid heartbeat
- Severe weakness

9.5 When to See a Doctor

Persistent fatigue, pale skin, or dizziness.

9.6 Specialist to Visit

Hematologist

10 Quick Specialist Reference Table

Disease	Recommended Specialist
Heart Disease	Cardiologist
Diabetes	Endocrinologist

Hypertension	Cardiologist / Internal Medicine
Asthma	Pulmonologist
Arthritis	Rheumatologist
Kidney Disease	Nephrologist
Liver Disease	Hepatologist / Gastroenterologist
Anemia	Hematologist

11 Emergency Symptoms Requiring Immediate Medical Attention

Seek emergency care immediately if experiencing:

- Severe chest pain
- Difficulty breathing
- Loss of consciousness
- Sudden weakness or paralysis
- Vomiting blood
- Severe allergic reaction
- Seizures

12 Conclusion

Early recognition of symptoms and timely consultation with the appropriate healthcare professional can significantly improve patient outcomes. This document serves as a general medical reference and should not replace professional medical diagnosis or treatment.

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